

Title: A change I made that made me go from a 48% win rate in silver, to 80% win rate the past 25 games

Score:

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Figured I'd share, as this change has drastically improved how I play.

In Gold/Silver, a lot of players actually have decent mechanics and knowledge of the game. They've watched a lot of guides, and played a lot of games.

But, what I've failed to realise, is that improving is not all about being able to just mindlessly do the correct thing and get fed every game. It sounds obvious, but hear me out. I saw a video of some guy saying "when I smurf in silver, I do the EXACT same thing as I do in challenger". This made me realise, Challenger players surfing in silver doesn't steamroll every game because they can 1v2 the enemy botlane at lvl 1, when the enemy botlane has lvl 2 advantage. The challenger player steamrolls, because he knows that he shouldn't be fighting at that point.

If a challenger Yorick players lanes against a Gold Irelia OTP, the challenger yorick wouldn't just magically be able to run Irelia over in 1v1 fights. The Irelia would actually be able to zone and bully the yorick. So the yorick would play it safe, and find somewhere else to get a lead, through wave management and recall timing for instance.

Rules of tempo, lvl advantage, gold lead and vision still apply to challengers when they're smurfing in silver. And I took this mindset to my own games. I was having trouble converting my leads into wins. But by identifying the concept of "there are certain rules that apply even tho im 15 1, or even if

im a challenger in silver", I drastically decreased the amount of mistakes I make. And it also improved my ability to identify mistakes. Instead of finding excuses for how it shouldn't be my fault that I died as a 10 1 fizz to a 5 9 Jax, I just started saying to myself "a challenger fizz wouldn't have killed this tax, not because his not good enough to do it, but because hes good enough to know he shouldn't try it in the first place".

Idk it might be placebo, but actually taking "rules" seriously, and not thinking "this is silver everyone suck I should win every game if im as good as I think I am", has helped me a crazy amount. This concept is explained as "don't make mistakes", but it's hard to take to heart when no one ever tells you that even challenger players would die in bronze if they made the same mistake.

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Edit: I had 48% win rate in about 300 games, and in my last 25 games I have 80% win rate. Title can be a little misleading lmao.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 506]

—hes good enough to know he shouldn't try it in the first place

And this is how high elo players have advantage while smurfing. Their enemy doesn't know what advantages they do/don't have and cannot capitalize on them properly.

[Comment 2 | Score: 1441]

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[Comment 3 | Score: 74]

Lmao mate youve figured it out

[Comment 4 | Score: 55]

I think climbing in low elo is all about punishing mistakes that happen in front of you and usually in those elos, they make a lot of them that you can take advantage of. Wasting their time is also worth it, especially the jungler.

[Comment 5 | Score: 47]

I'm a Master support player and I tried playing with a gold friend on a real gold account playing only adc and I was amazed how people actually know how to play their champs I was really expecting baboon plays but they were pretty good, but unfortunately, they tend to be bad on macro which I guess is the point that separates the ranks.

TL:DR: got sh*t on by gold players by underestimating their mechanics on a few games on a gold smurf, but learned that they're bad at macro and proceeded to win further games :'D